

The Roman Empire was one of the largest and most influential civilizations in human history. At its peak, it stretched across Europe, North Africa, and the Middle East. The Romans were master engineers, known for their construction of aqueducts, complex road networks, and monumental architecture like the Colosseum. The empire's legal system and governance models heavily influenced the development of modern Western democracies. The eventual fall of the Western Roman Empire in 476 AD marked the beginning of the Middle Ages in Europe.